



Absence Management Policy

Written June 2025 – Review date June 2027

INTRODUCTION

Emmanuel Christian School recognises the benefits of having a healthy and committed workforce whilst at the same time having a robust and clearly understood procedure for managing sickness absence. This policy outlines our approach to managing attendance in the workplace.

The school leadership team understands that people will be occasionally unwell and respects that employees may need to be absent when they are not well enough to work. However, high levels of absence during term time make it difficult for the school to cover all aspects of the curriculum and pupil care. It also has an impact on other employees who have to cover the absence.

Emmanuel Christian School is committed to ensuring that your job and working environment do not cause or contribute to ill health.

The senior leadership team is committed to promoting a culture of attendance where employees feel valued and supported and committed to the school and their colleagues.

Emmanuel Christian School takes a work focussed approach to help minimise the impact of ill health on an employee's attendance. Being ill or injured does not always prevent an employee from getting to or undertaking some work. A work focused approach involves:

- a) Early intervention to enable help and support to be identified. The sooner action is taken, the better the chances are of an employee making a full and speedy return to work. Simple adjustments can enable employees to return to work safely before their symptoms completely disappear. Employees can normally return before they are 100% fit.
- b) A greater emphasis on the manager and employee working together to remove barriers to work. Sickness absence is not just a matter of ill-health. It is affected by a combination of the health condition, personal and work/organisational factors. The last two factors get more important the longer the absence. Work in a well-managed workplace is a treatment for people recovering from sickness absence and an early return to work improves both mental and physical recovery.
- c) Attendance discussions will focus on what an employee can do rather than what they can't, enabling them where possible to remain in work instead of taking sickness absence.

The senior leadership team will support employees in achieving a satisfactory level of attendance by helping them to remain in work when they experience ill health, or return to work as soon as possible following a period of sickness absence.

During long term sickness absence, review meetings will take place to provide an opportunity for the employee and manager to identify any help needed to enable the employee to return to work as soon as they are well enough. Open and constructive discussion between all parties is essential for successful management of sickness absence and return to work.

The senior leadership team will take appropriate steps to improve attendance where levels of sickness absence cause concern; this may include formal action. The senior leadership team will use written warnings to address unsatisfactory attendance.

Dismissal will only be considered as a final option where the level of sickness absence cannot be supported.

Employees are responsible for managing their own attendance and should attend work unless they are unfit to do so. Good management can lead to good health, well-being and improved performance. This policy supports managers in managing attendance effectively and encourages employees to work with their manager to achieve and maintain a satisfactory level of attendance.

Employees Responsibilities

You are expected to attend work for the hours you are contractually obliged to work unless you are too ill to do so.

Take measures to minimise your risk of being absent from work due to illness.

Notify your manager if you are too ill to come into work, preferably the night before or by 7.30am the day you will be absent.

Provide work for the classes that you will be absent from unless your illness prevents you from doing so.

Keep in regular contact with your line manager during any absence.

Provide a self-certificate (for sick absences of less than 5 days); or Statement of Fitness for Work or 'Fit Note'. (for absences of 5 days or more)

Take an active part in return to work interviews engaging constructively with your manager about the reasons for your absence and emerging trends. This includes where appropriate exploring whether temporary workplace adaptations could be implemented that would enable you to undertake some elements of your role or another role to enable you to attend work.

All employees at the school can expect the following:

Emmanuel Christian School will ensure that your job and working environment do not cause or contribute to ill health. The senior leadership team will take all reasonable steps to support you if your health affects your ability to attend work, and or do your job, and will give you opportunity to improve your attendance within a reasonable period of time if there are concerns.

All absences will be recorded on individual staff record cards **Annex A** that will be retained securely by the Head Teacher in the absence management folder in line with our Data Protection obligations.

When you return from any sick absence you must have a return to work interview with your manager where you will discuss your current absence and review your sickness absence over the last 12 months. These will be recorded on the Form at **Annex B**, and be retained securely by the Head Teacher in the absence management folder in line with our Data Protection obligations.

Formal unsatisfactory attendance action will not be considered unless your absence over the last 12 months has reached an unacceptable level, based on the Bradford Factor. A short explanation of how the Bradford Factor is calculated is found at **Annex H** We acknowledge that each case of ill health will be different and relevant mitigation will be considered on a case by case basis. However, reaching the orange zone will most likely trigger the start of a conversation relating to addressing absence levels.

Your manager will discuss with you at your return to work interview if they have concerns about your absence record and those concerns will be recorded on the form **Annex B**. They will also inform you if further action is being considered.

If you are absent for more than 3 weeks, your manager will work with you to devise a return to work plan, taking into account any available medical advice. This empowers an employee to influence their return to work and can significantly boost well-being and confidence. This plan (**Annex C**) will be tailored to the individual and will include:

- a) The goal of the plan
- b) The time period of the plan
- c) Information about alternate working arrangements
- d) Information about changes to terms and conditions
- e) What checks will be made to make sure the plan is put into practice
- f) Dates when the plan will be reviewed.

Unsatisfactory attendance as a result of short term or long term absence may result in formal disciplinary action being taken against you.

Should unsatisfactory attendance continue then further disciplinary action may be taken up to and including dismissal.

You have the right to appeal to the governing body against a warning or dismissal.

You will be treated with dignity and respect at all times, and your manager will take decisions promptly or without unavoidable delay.

Medical Appointments

Employees are expected where possible to make appointments to attend doctors and dentists etc outside school working hours. It is recognised that this is not always possible and reasonable time will be given for attendance for hospital appointments etc. Where possible you will be expected to return to school following your appointment, and attend school before the appointment if it is later in the day.

Other Absences (Non-Sickness Related)

While this policy primarily relates to sickness absence, we recognise that staff may occasionally need to request time away from work for other reasons.

- **Leave of Absence Requests:**

Staff may request time off for personal, family, or other reasons by completing a Leave of Absence Request Form. This should be submitted to the Head Teacher (or designated senior leader) as far in advance as possible. Each request will be considered on a case-by-case basis, taking into account the reason for absence, impact on the school, and statutory entitlements.

- **Types of Absence That May Be Considered include (but are not limited to):**

- Bereavement or compassionate leave
- Jury service or other statutory duties
- Family emergencies or childcare responsibilities (as covered under the Employment Rights Act 1996)
- Weddings, graduations or other significant family events
- Unpaid leave for personal reasons
- Professional training or development (where agreed in advance)

- **Approval:**

All leave of absence is at the discretion of the Head Teacher, except where statutory entitlements apply (e.g. jury service, emergency dependants' leave).

- **Recording:**

Authorised absences will be recorded separately from sickness absence but will still form part of an individual's personnel record.

- **Unauthorised Absence:**

Time taken without prior approval (except in cases of emergency) will be treated as unauthorised absence and may lead to disciplinary action in line with the school's staff code of conduct.

Keeping in Contact

Employees

- a) Notify your manager if you are too ill to come into work, preferably the night before or by 7.30am the day you will be absent.
- b) Agree with your manager how regularly they would like you to update them on your condition.
- c) As your employer, we reserve the right to make reasonable contact with you during a period of absence.

Managers

- a) It is a key responsibility of line managers to keep in regular contact with any of their staff who are absent. They will know the individual and should be able to handle any sensitive issues. Don't pass the responsibility to others unless there are sound reasons for doing so. Make sure your conversation with the absent employee is clearly focused on their health and well-being and their return to work. Try to focus as much on what the employee can do as well as things they may need help with.
- b) Minor illness: When employees notify you of a minor illness that is likely to end within seven days further contact is not really necessary. However, a Return To Work Interview must be completed to get people up to speed and to discuss any underlying issues if this sort of absence happens often.
- c) Traumatic injury or sudden illness: Extend your sympathies and use discretion until the longer prognosis is known.
- d) Planned treatment: Employees may welcome hospital visits but try to check with relatives first.
- e) Stress: If you are notified that an employee is suffering from a stress-related illness make contact within a week. But it is unlikely they will be ready to discuss returning at this stage. Use discretion until the longer-term prognosis is known.
- f) Do
 - ❖ Remember that an employee's medical and health information is classed as sensitive data under Data Protection legislation and must be treated in the strictest confidence at all times, unless express consent has been given.
 - ❖ Create a climate of trust by agreeing beforehand your methods, frequency and reasons for keeping in contact with absent employees;
 - ❖ Keep a note of contacts made;
 - ❖ Be flexible, treat each case individually but on a fair and consistent basis;
 - ❖ Welcome your employee back after their absence during the return to work interview
 - ❖ Give your employees the opportunity to discuss, in private, concerns about their health or other matters that are affecting their performance or attendance;
 - ❖ Remember that medication can have side effects on things like physical stamina, mood, machinery operation and safety critical tasks.
- g) Don't
 - ❖ Wait until someone is on long-term sick leave before taking action;
 - ❖ Delay making contact or pass responsibility to others unless there are sound reasons for doing so;
 - ❖ Make assumptions about your employee's situation;
 - ❖ Say that colleagues are under pressure or that work is piling up;
 - ❖ Forget that recovery times for the same condition can vary significantly from person to person.

Return to Work Interview

Employee

- a) On your first working day, back in school following an absence, complete the self-certification part of Annex B with information about your absence attaching medical certificates if the absence was longer than 5 working days.
- b) Pass the form to your line manager on the same day.

Managers:

- a) Arrange a time to complete the return to work interview preferably on the first day of the employees return.
- b) Review previous 12 months absence record and note on Annex B provided by employee. Also review Bradford Factor score and consider if action is suggested whether appropriate in this case.
- c) Discuss absence with employee.
- d) Discuss if any reasonable adjustments need to be made
- e) Review all absences in last 12 months with employee and
 - ❖ If there are no concerns note this in the discussion area of Annex B and make this clear to the employee.
 - ❖ If there are concerns that the level of absence is unacceptable for the school, raise this with the employee and explain that you will be arranging a further meeting to consider whether it is appropriate to take formal action. (A further meeting will be necessary in this scenario as the employee has to be given the opportunity to be accompanied to the meeting by a work place colleague) If formal action is to be considered, letter **Annex D** should be sent to the employee giving them 5 days' notice of the meeting.
- f) Ensure that the main points of the discussion are recorded on the return to work interview form.
- g) File the record in the absence management folder.

Formal Action – Short Term Absence (absences of less than 4 weeks)

Employee

- a) Your manager will invite you to a meeting to discuss your attendance once your absences have reached a level that is considered unacceptable.
- b) You will be given opportunity to be accompanied to these meetings by one person of your choice. They are attending to support you but cannot take part in the meeting.
- c) The table below summarises the actions that can be taken at each stage of the formal process.

Stage 1 First written warning	This warning is given when your level of absence is considered unacceptable. You will be given a 6-month review period during which your attendance must be acceptable. If your attendance is acceptable during the review period no further action will be taken. If during the review period your attendance continues to be below an acceptable level your manager must move to the final written warning stage.
Stage 2 Final Written Warning	This warning is given when your level of has continued to be below an acceptable level after a first written warning. You will be given a 6-month review period during which your attendance must be acceptable. If your attendance is acceptable during the review period no further action will be taken. If during the review period your attendance continues to be below an acceptable level your manager must move to the dismissal stage.
Stage 3 Dismissal	Dismissal meetings will be conducted by the head teacher. The head teacher will invite you to a meeting and consider if it is appropriate to dismiss you. If a decision is made not to dismiss you your attendance will continue to be monitored for the remainder of the review period and further absences may lead to a further meeting to consider dismissal. If dismissal is appropriate you will be asked to leave immediately and your notice period will be paid.

Managers

- a) The three stages for formal action are:
 - ❖ First written warning
 - ❖ Final Written warning
 - ❖ Dismissal
- b) A first or final written warning is followed by a 6-month review period. If attendance during this period is satisfactory then no further action is taken. If attendance during the review period is unsatisfactory then formal action resumes from the next stage. This means that:
 - ❖ A final written warning is considered if a first written warning has already been given
 - ❖ Dismissal is considered if a final written warning has already been given.
- c) When inviting an employee to a formal action meeting, the letter Annex D should be used.
- d) A written record must be made of the meeting
- e) At the meeting, the manager should:
 - ❖ Tell the employee that their absence is unacceptably high
 - ❖ Have the sick record card detailing the absences within the 12-month period and the return to work interviews relevant to the absences within that 12 months.
 - ❖ Explain that the purpose of the meeting is not to question whether the absences were genuine but to discuss the level of absence and what if anything can be done to reduce them in the future.
 - ❖ Explain that the purpose of the meeting is to support the employee in order to enable them to meet the required attendance standard as well as considering if formal action is appropriate.
 - ❖ Discuss with the employee why they are having problems. Ask them to discuss the situation with their GP if they have not already done so.
 - ❖ Discuss whether there is anything other than their illness/injury affecting them.
 - ❖ Review/ discuss any possible reasonable adjustments.
 - ❖ Explore if there are any lifestyle choices that are impacting the employee's health.
 - ❖ Decide if the warning is appropriate or not. If the warning is not appropriate issue letter **Annex E** should be sent to the employee indicating there is no further action at this time but that absence will continue to be monitored and that further action may be taken if attendance does not improve, or letter **Annex F** if a warning is to be given and **Annex G** if dismissal is being considered. The reasons for giving or not giving a warning should be recorded by the manager to provide an appeal manager with a rational should an appeal be made.

Formal Action – Long Term Absence (absence of more than 4 weeks)

You are required to keep in touch with your manager throughout your absence.

If you are absent for a continuous period of time your manager will follow the following procedures:

Stage 1 28 Day attendance review meeting	Once you have been absent for 28 continuous days, your line manager will arrange a review meeting with you. This discussion is to keep you up to date with work issues, to discuss if you need any help and support in returning to work and how long you are likely to be absent for and any changes in your medical condition. Your manager will send you a record of your discussion and any action points resulting from it.
Stage 2 On-going monthly attendance review meetings	At the second review meeting (a month after the first meeting) your manager will arrange the meeting and discuss with you any support you need to return to work and whether or not you are likely to return to work in a reasonable time scale. If return is likely within a reasonable time your manager will continue with on-going monthly attendance meetings. If your manager considers that your return to work is

	unlikely within a reasonable timescale they will move to stage 3 of the process. Your manager will send you a record of your discussion and any action points resulting from it.
Stage 3 Head teacher and HR Governor Involvement	When your manager considers that it is unlikely that you will return to work in a reasonable time frame, they will arrange a case conference with the head teacher and HR governor and review your absence. At that meeting agreement will be reached on how to further manage your absence and what further action should be taken to support you and also whether or not to move to Stage 4.
Stage 4 Dismissal	If at any time during your ongoing review process your manager believes that your absence can no longer be supported by the school, the head teacher will invite you to a meeting and consider if it is appropriate to dismiss you. If a decision is made not to dismiss you your absence will continue to be monitored but continued absence may lead to a further meeting to consider dismissal. If dismissal is appropriate you will be asked to leave immediately and your notice period will be paid.

Appeals

Where a decision results in a penalty, employees are entitled to appeal against the decision to the next stage in the management chain, E.G. if an SLT member of staff has given a decision resulting in a penalty, the appeal will go to the Head Teacher. If the Head Teacher has given a decision resulting in a penalty, the appeal will go to the chair of governors. You should appeal in writing within 10 days of the decision. You must set out the grounds of your appeal and state whether you are appealing against:

- ❖ Procedural errors
- ❖ The decision including where there is new information/evidence that may change the outcome of the original decision.

The Head teacher or chair of governors (or vice chair if the chair is not available) as appropriate will write to you within 5 days of receiving your appeal and will invite you to a meeting using Annex D, giving you at least 5 days' notice of the meeting and the opportunity to be accompanied by a work place colleague.

The Head Teacher or chair of governors (or vice chair if the chair is not available) as appropriate will:

- ❖ Ensure they understand the grounds of the appeal
- ❖ Ensure they have all the papers
- ❖ Ensure that procedures have been followed correctly at every stage.
- ❖ Ensure the decision was fair and reasonable
- ❖ Consider any new material/evidence
- ❖ Consider if the decision is consistent with decisions in similar cases, but takes into account the individual circumstances of the case.
- ❖ Ensure that the employee has opportunity to present their appeal.
- ❖ Ensure that the minutes of the meeting are taken.

After the meeting the Head Teacher or chair of governors (or vice chair if the chair is not available) as appropriate will:

- ❖ Agree and sign the minutes
- ❖ Consider whether the original decision should stand.
- ❖ Notify the employee of the decision within 5 days of the meeting.

- ❖ Ensure that the decision records the main points of the discussion and the evidence presented, respond to any points left unresolved at the meeting, explains how their decision was reached, and is consistent with the facts and is fair and reasonable.
- ❖ All documents should be copied to the file and the file retained by the school business manager.

Review

This policy should be read in conjunction with the staff code of conduct.

This policy will be reviewed on a bi-annual basis. This latest review was completed in June 2023.

Formally agreed through Governors compliance:	
Signed Julian Mercik – Chair of Governors	28/07/25
Signed Andy Harris – Head Teacher	28/07/25
Review Date:	29/07/27

Sick Absence Record

Name:	
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Absent From	Absent to	Number of working days Absent	Number of Days in rolling 12 months	Number of Absences in rolling 12 months	Bradford Factor calculation + Action level	Date self-certificate filed	Date of return to work interview	Formal Action required (Y,N)

Formal Action Record

Date formal action Commenced	Type of formal action	Final Decision	Review period set? (Y,N)	Dates of review period (From -To)	Appeal (Y,N)	Date of Appeal	Appeal Decision

Self-Certification of Sickness

This form should be completed for the first 5 days of any sick absence.

Name:	
Please give details of your sickness:	
What date did your sickness begin? (the first day that you were absent from work)	
What date did your sickness end? (the last day you were absent from work sick)	
For absences longer than 5 working days you will be required to provide a fit note. Please indicate if a fit note has been provided.	Fit note provided ☐
Was your sickness caused by an accident at work or an industrial disease?	Yes ☐ No ☐
If yes please provide full details:	

Declaration

I confirm that the information I have given is correct.

Signed:	
Dated:	

Return to Work Record

This meeting should be completed for all periods of sick absence, preferably on their first day back in work. The absence should be recorded on the Sick Absence Record.

Part One – Return to work should be completed for all spells of absence.

Part Two – Welfare Chat should also be completed if the member of staff has had 2 or more spells of absence in the rolling 12 month period.

Part One – Return to work Interview – (Line Manager to complete)

Team Member Name:					
Date Absence Began:		Date of Return to Work:		Total days Absent from Work:	

Explain Reason for Absence:	
Is the member of staff fit for work?	Yes ☐ No ☐ (If no suggest speaks to GP)
Correct contact during absence?	Yes ☐ No ☐ (If no explain that contact must be maintained during absence)
Member of staff sought medical advice during absence?	Yes ☐ No ☐
If yes; who did they speak to, when did they speak to them and what was the advice?	
Medical Note Received?	GP Fit Note ☐ Self Cert ☐ (if GP fit note place on sick file)
Is the member of staff covered by a live GP Fit note?	Yes ☐ No ☐ (If yes, specifically discuss their fitness to be in work below)
Is the member of staff on medication that may affect their role?	Yes ☐ No ☐ (If yes please include any details of temporary adjustments below)
If the member of staff is covered by a live GP Fit Note, discuss their fitness to be in work and record these details below.	
Based on your discussion and any medical advice received, detail any immediate temporary adjustments to support their return to work from this occasion of sick absence.	
Was this the first spell of absence in the last 12 months?	Yes ☐ No ☐ (If yes go straight to declaration, if no complete Part 2 – welfare chat)

Part Two – Welfare Chat (Manager, Leader, Supervisor to complete)

Please complete this section if the member of staff has experienced 2 or more occasions of absence in the rolling 12 month period

Are any of the absences in the last 12 months for the same medical condition or linked to a medical condition?

Yes ☐ No ☐ (If yes what is the medical condition and is any reasonable support required at this time? Please detail below:

If the absences are not for the same medical condition or linked to a medical condition, would any additional supports or adjustments help to prevent any further occasions of absence? Please detail below:

Any further details shared by the member of staff or any further relevant information:

Record the Bradford Factor score and suggested course of action:

Discuss suggested course of action with member of staff and record main points of discussion: *(e.g. come concern; member of staff aware next absence may invoke a penalty discussion or further action required – meeting with manager to discuss potential penalty etc)*

DECLARATION

I understand that the information in this document will be placed on my personnel record and that it may be used by the senior leadership team for the purposes of managing my employment, such as absence management or capability assessment. I also understand that I may need to attend a formal meeting to further discuss my absence in line with Emmanuel Christian School's absence management policy.

(Both the manager and member of staff should sign this record.)

Member of Staffs Name:		Member of staff's signature:	
Date of Meeting:		Time of meeting:	
Manager's Name:		Manager's signature:	

Annex C

Return to Work Plan

Details: These return to work arrangements are for:

Name of worker	
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Pre-Illness work:

Job title	Days/hours of work

Return to Work Arrangements:

Duties or tasks to be undertaken
<i>Describe the specific duties and tasks required. Include any physical and other requirements, e.g. lifting, sitting, rotation of tasks, etc.</i>

Workplace supports, aids or modifications to be provided
<i>Describe workplace supports, aids or modifications, e.g. rest breaks, buddy system, special tools, equipment, training, etc.</i>

Specific duties or tasks to be avoided
<i>Describe the specific duties and tasks that are to be avoided or restricted, e.g. lifting, tasks that are only to be undertaken with the assistance of another worker.</i>

Return to Work Arrangements

Medical restrictions
<i>Describe the restrictions on the most recent Fit note or from other sources, e.g. phone call with the worker's doctor or healthcare provider. From what date do these restrictions apply?</i>

Hours of work

It is recommended that reduced hours are gradually increased where appropriate.

Week 1	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Total p/w
Week 2	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Total p/w
Week 3	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Total p/w
Week 4	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Total p/w

Manager	Start date:
	Review date:
	Date prepared:

Signature of key people involved

Member of Staff – I will participate in these return to work arrangements.		
Name	Signed	Date
Manager – I will implement these return to work arrangements in the work area.		
Name	Signed	Date

Notes/additional information

If there is any additional information you wish to include in this form, please attach any supporting documentation e.g. medical reports, position description, photos etc.

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Emmanuel Christian School

Didsbury Street

Leicester

LE3 1QP

27 August 2025

Personal

[Name]

[Address]

Dear *[Name]*

You have been absent for *[insert number of days absent and number of spells of absence]* between *[last date of most recent absence]* and *[date 12 months back from last day of most recent absence]*. This level of absence is unacceptable and I must now consider whether formal action is appropriate.

I would like to meet with you on *[date giving the member of staff at least 5 days' notice]* at *[time]* at *[location]*. If you are unable to attend at this time please let me know as soon as possible so an alternative date can be arranged.

This is not about whether your sick absences were genuine, but about your level of sickness absence and what can be done to improve it. Emmanuel Christian School expects the highest level of attendance from all of its employees to enable us to continue to deliver a good quality education to our students.

You have the right to be accompanied by a work place colleague. Please let me know if you intend to be accompanied and who they are.

The absence management procedure is designed to help bring your attendance up to the expected standard and I will give you the opportunity at the meeting to discuss any problems that may be affecting your attendance. However following the meeting I will have to decide whether or not you should be given a First Written Warning. If your attendance level does not improve within the specified timescale, your employment with the school could be affected.

I will let you know what further action will be taken within 5 working days of the meeting.

Yours Sincerely

[Insert name and position]



Emmanuel Christian School

Didsbury Street

Leicester

LE3 1QP

27 August 2025

Personal

[Name]

[Address]

Dear *[Name]*

Thank you for meeting me on *[insert date]* to discuss your level of sickness absence. This letter summarises our discussion and tells you what could happen if you do not meet the standards expected of you within the time limits I have described.

We discussed the following: *[detail the points discussed including any agreed action and progress; any medical or other factors preventing them from returning to work and whether you have asked them to speak to their GP about the advice and support they can provide]*

I have taken into account everything that we talked about at the meeting and have decided not to issue you with a First Written Warning at this stage. This is because *[insert the reasons why the sanction has not been given]*. However if your attendance deteriorates further I will reconsider my decision.

If you have any questions or concerns, I am happy to discuss these with you.

Yours Sincerely

[Insert name and position]



Emmanuel Christian School

Didsbury Street

Leicester

LE3 1QP

27 August 2025

Personal

[Name]

[Address]

Dear *[Name]*

Thank you for meeting me on *[insert date]* to discuss your attendance at work during the period from *[date]* to *[date]*. This letter summarises our discussion and tells you what action I have decided to take.

We discussed the following: *[detail the points discussed including any agreed action and progress; any medical or other factors preventing them from returning to work and whether you have asked them to speak to their GP about the advice and support they can provide]*

I have decided to give you a first Written Warning and will monitor your attendance for 6 months from *[date of meeting]* to *[date 6 months later]*. This is called the review period. If your attendance is unsatisfactory at any time in the review period your case will be considered again and I may give you a Final written warning. However if your attendance deteriorates further I will reconsider my decision.

If your attendance continues to be unsatisfactory after being given a final written warning, you may be dismissed.

You have the right of appeal against this decision. If you choose to appeal you should write to *[insert either head teacher or chair of governors as appropriate in accordance with the absence management policy]* within 10 working days of receiving this written decision. You should clearly state the grounds of appeal and the outcome you are seeking. *[Name of person considering the appeal]* will arrange a meeting with you within 5 working days of receipt of your appeal letter. In preparing your appeal you have the right to be accompanied by a work colleague.

If you have any questions or concerns, I am happy to discuss these with you.

Yours Sincerely

[Insert name and position]



Emmanuel Christian School

Didsbury Street

Leicester

LE3 1QP

27 August 2025

Personal

[Name]

[Address]

Dear *[Name]*

Thank you for meeting me on *[insert date]* to discuss your attendance at work during the period from *[date]* to *[date]*. This letter summarises our discussion and tells you what action I have decided to take.

We discussed the following: *[detail the points discussed; any medical or other factors preventing them from returning to work]*

I have decided to dismiss you for poor attendance at work with immediate effect. You will be paid for your notice period which will be for *[state the length of notice period]*. You are dismissed because, despite repeated warnings, your attendance at work has not improved. The action taken has been documented in *[number]* letters of reprimand which you have received.

You have the right of appeal against this decision. If you choose to appeal you should write to *[insert either head teacher or chair of governors as appropriate in accordance with the absence management policy]* within 10 working days of receiving this written decision. You should clearly state the grounds of appeal and the outcome you are seeking. *[Name of person considering the appeal]* will arrange a meeting with you within 5 working days of receipt of your appeal letter. In preparing your appeal you have the right to be accompanied by a work colleague.

If you have any questions or concerns, I am happy to discuss these with you.

Yours Sincerely

[Insert name and position]

The Bradford Factor

The Bradford Factor is a formula that allows ECS to apply a relative weighting to employee sick absence. The Bradford Factor supports the principal that repeat absences have a greater operational impact than long term sick. It provides a useful benchmark tool enabling managers to have an assessment score for an individual staff absence record. ECS will utilise the factor score as a trigger guide to implement more comprehensive support and monitoring procedures for employees as appropriate.

The factor score is calculated using the calculator found at <https://www.bradfordfactorcalculator.com>

The score will then be compared to the heat map to gauge if further action is suggested. A copy of the heat map is represented below:-

No Concern	0
Some Concern	22
Action Required	45
Consider Disciplinary	100
Serious Disciplinary Likely	900

Enter the 3 Bradford factor levels that you wish to use as gauges to change the Bradford factor heat map below

Absence occurrences		1	1.5	2	2.5	3	3.5	4	4.5	5	5.5	6
1	1	1	1.5	2	2.5	3	3.5	4	4.5	5	5.5	6
2	8	12	16	20	24	28	32	36	40	44	48	
3	27	40.5	54	67.5	81	94.5	108	121.5	135	148.5	162	
4	64	96	128	160	192	224	256	288	320	352	384	
5	125	187.5	250	312.5	375	437.5	500	562.5	625	687.5	750	
6	216	324	432	540	648	756	864	972	1080	1188	1296	
7	343	514.5	686	857.5	1029	1200.5	1372	1543.5	1715	1886.5	2058	
8	512	768	1024	1280	1536	1792	2048	2304	2560	2816	3072	
9	729	1093.5	1458	1822.5	2187	2551.5	2916	3280.5	3645	4009.5	4374	
10	1000	1500	2000	2500	3000	3500	4000	4500	5000	5500	6000	
11	1331	1996.5	2662	3327.5	3993	4658.5	5324	5989.5	6655	7320.5	7986	
12	1728	2592	3456	4320	5184	6048	6912	7776	8640	9504	10368	
13	2197	3295.5	4394	5492.5	6591	7689.5	8788	9886.5	10985	12083.5	13182	
14	2744	4116	5488	6860	8232	9604	10976	12348	13720	15092	16464	